



BANKIGA DHEXE EE SOOMAALIYA
البنك المركزي الصومالي
CENTRAL BANK OF SOMALIA

Somali National Quick Response (QR)Code Standard & Operational Guidelines



SOMQR

(May 2023)



بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

In the name of Allah, most gracious, most merciful



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Version Information

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May 2023	1	Initial Publication



Abbreviations

S.N.	Abbreviation	Description
1	QR	Quick Response
2	CBS	Central bank of Somalia
3	KYM	Know Your Merchant
4	MDR	Merchant Discount Rate
5	OS	Operating System
6	OTP	One Time Password
7	P2P	Person to Person
8	PIN	Personal Identification Number
9	PSO	Payments System Operator
10	PSP	Payments Service Provider
11	CVV	Card Verification Value
12	UI	User Interface
13	UX	User Experience
14	BLE	Bluetooth Low-energy interface
15	NFC	Near-field Communication
16	KYC	Know Your Merchant
17	SPS	Somali Payments Switch
18	MNO	Mobile Money Operator
19	MFI	Microfinance Institution
20	IBAN	International bank Account Number



Executive Summary

The Central Bank of Somalia (CBS) as the financial institutions regulator in Somalia continues to modernize and digitalize the national payment systems on the principles of interoperability, financial inclusion and efficiency into a digital economy.

In collaboration with stakeholders, CBS and 13 commercial banks under the Somali Bankers Association (SBA) setup a strategic payments company Somali Payments Switch (SPS). The company handles the national digital payments platform that makes banking, e-commerce and mobile money payments interoperable to encourage cashless means of payment for customers and merchants across banks, MNOs, MFIs and others.

A unified National Quick Response (QR) code named SOMQR is a standard that has been defined by various stakeholders including banks, MNOs and Fintechs under the guidance of CBS to cover an interoperability gap. SOMQR complies with the international EMVCo QR specifications.

SOMQR standard will revolutionise the payment landscape in Somalia as a low-cost, scalable, secure and interoperable solution towards a cashless society. The QR code will enable merchants to receive their money instantly and empower the consumer to control the payment using his/her bank App or Mobile Money provider Wallet.

The interoperable identification of merchants and other stakeholders on SOMQR code will boost financial inclusion through a retail payment framework that provides swift, convenient, anytime-anywhere payment services for merchant payments (P2M) and person-to-person (P2P) transfers.

The benefits of QR Codes are many including affordability, easy to deploy by customers, sellers and buyers plus government entities who receive payments for revenue collections such as tax, customs duties, and other government services fees. However, when standardised for national usage, they require customer awareness and the stakeholders to ensure that risks in technology infrastructure, security and adherence to the system operational guidelines laid out by CBS are closely followed.

I would like to thank all the QR standardizing committee members and their Chairman Dr. Sseggujja Hussein plus all the stakeholders that were engaged during this process.

Lastly, the National QR code for Somalia-SOMQR as part of the National instant payment system will play a key transformational role towards digitising retail payments in both the private and government payment services in Somalia. It sets a retail payments platform for financial inclusion, efficiency and interoperability in Somalia.

Abdirahman Mohamed Abdullahi

Governor, Central Bank of Somalia



1. Introduction

The Central Bank of Somalia (CBS) under the mandate to regulate the National Payment System is responsible for the supervision and oversight of the authorised payment service providers in the country to promote innovation, organise and provide operational efficiency, customer convenience, security, and support interoperability and minimise costs across the payments sector.

The payments landscape in Somalia is shifting from cash to digital mode with innovative solutions. One such Payment innovation in the retail space is Quick Response (QR) code payments as an excellent alternative to cash or card-based payments.

2. Importance of QR codes

The growing use of the internet and number of smart phone users facilitates adoption of QR based payments. The 'fear of proximity' drives the need of low-cost contact-less payment mode, and QR codes are the best suited to address this challenge.

Globally, the central banks of these countries Hong Kong (HKQR), Singapore (SGQR), Thailand (ThaiQR), Vietnam (VietQR), Indonesia (QRIS), Philippines (QRPh), Jordan (Jo_QR), Tanzania (TanQR), Ghana (GhQR), Nepal (NepalQR), Malaysia (DuitNow) and others have all launched national QR code standards for retail payments and some of these countries have integrated their QR codes for cross border transactions.

The main reason for such uptake has been the acceleration of digitization of economies and low-cost solutions that enable migration from the plastic era in digital payments and bring merchants and individuals online faster.

3. Need for a Standard QR in Somalia

Quick Response codes are emerging as a preferred mode of payments amongst consumers and merchants equally. Wallets are largely responsible for popularising mobile payments across globe and have greatly influenced the consumer's behaviour to scan QR for payments. In Somalia, many licensed banks and PSOs are already on this journey of payment trends.

Although this market led trend of QR payments has its advantages, most of these QR providers are closed and not interoperable which inconveniences customers who want to use a phone to pay at multiple retailers.

As the number of payment systems operators and providers expands, there is an increasing need to develop standards to bring in uniformity and provide equal opportunity for all players in payment space. This standard provides three major payment benefits- Interoperability, Scalability and Security. This document provides a Technical Standard Specification for QR codes and an Operational framework for its implementation and usage in Somalia.

**...The payments
landscape in Somalia
is shifting from cash
to digital mode with
innovative solutions.**



4. Framework for QR based payments

This section defines the broad framework for QR payments in Somalia. Based on the provider's role in the QR payment lifecycle, the framework shall be suitably applicable. All the guidelines, procedures developed by a Scheme should follow related CBS directives.

4.1 Definitions

The following are parties to a QR code-initiated transactions:

1. **Acquirers:** Are the financial institutions or payment service providers (e-money operators), responsible for enrolling merchants, assigning merchant IDs, maintaining merchant accounts and settling merchants.
2. **Issuers:** Are the network members who create and own customers and facilitate payments from current accounts, savings accounts, mobile based e-money accounts and cards.
3. **Customers:** Are the individuals or entities using Issuers' Application for SOMQR based payment services.
4. **Merchants:** Are business entities registered with acquirers who accept SOMQR based payments.
5. **Network Members:** Are Banks and Payment System Operators (PSOs), Payment Service Providers (PSPs) and their successors that join the network under the terms and conditions stipulated in the respective membership agreement under a particular network to their customers.
6. **Payment System Operator (PSO):** Are the entities licensed as PSO by CBS.
7. **Payment Service Provider (PSP):** Are the entities licensed as PSP by CBS.

8. **Scheme/Network:** Means a shared payment network developed and managed by a Payment System Operator (PSO) which allows transactions and payments routing among and within its members.

4.2 Eligibility for Acquiring and Issuing.

The merchant acquiring and issuing can be done by Banks and Financial Institutions and Payment Service Providers (PSPs) licensed by CBS.

4.3 Responsibilities of a Network:

1. A Network operator shall maintain and manage the infrastructure and technology components, prepare and implement necessary business continuity plans (BCP) to ensure that the Network is not disrupted or services are not suspended at any point of time.
2. A Network shall prepare mechanisms, policies and procedures for the settlement of disputes between the individuals and parties involved in transactions and enforce them throughout the network and participants.
3. A Scheme shall settle the transactions and provide the transaction reports, fees and charges details, fee sharing reports and settlement reports to the network participants through secured media for timely reconciliation of accounts of all the participants.
4. A Scheme or Network shall provide necessary system interface and support to the participants to integrate and operate under the Network.
5. A Network shall prepare necessary operating procedures, rules and regulations regarding the transaction settlement and reconciliation, fees and charges, duties, rights, liabilities and remedies of each individual involved in the transaction. All the participants shall follow and abide by all such operating procedures, rules and regulations of Network.



4.4 Responsibilities of Acquirer:

1. The Acquirer must ensure to undertake KYC and due diligence for all on-boarded merchants.
2. If the acquirer provides for instant on-boarding convenience, the acquirer must ensure to provide basic training to merchants and ensure the KYC and merchant on-boarding guidelines are not compromised at any point of time.
3. Prior to entering into a Merchant Agreement, an Acquirer shall ensure that the Merchant is a registered entity as per prevailing laws.
4. Merchant on-boarding process shall at minimum include the following:
 - a. Pre-screening
 - b. Identity verification and Know Your Merchant
 - c. Business review of merchant
 - d. Assurance that the merchant shall keep customer data confidential.
 - e. Merchant agreement
5. The Acquirer may seek additional documents from merchants while screening and approving terms. For example, for online Merchants who sell products or services exclusively over the Internet the following review shall have to be conducted by the acquirer:
 - a. Secure network, systems and applications.
 - b. Customer transactions data to be encrypted during transmission.
 - c. Implementation of vulnerability management program.
 - d. Restrict access to customer data based on "Need to Know and Right to Know".
 - e. Implementation of access controls.
 - f. Tracking and monitoring all access to network resources and customer data.
 - g. Regular testing of security systems and processes
 - h. Maintenance of information security policy
 - i. Content of website and merchant information standards
 - j. Name displayed on website matching merchant description.
 - k. Privacy policy
 - l. Products offered for sale
 - m. Links to other sites
 - n. Minimum International website data security requirements.
6. The QR provided by the Acquirer must at all times be compliant to the QR standards prescribed by the CBS.
7. The provider shall solely be responsible for the transactions initiated by the merchant – similar to the guidelines prescribed by the respective Scheme/Network.
8. The Acquirer must provide the marketing name of the merchant in the QR or by means of API to the App provider.
9. In case of aggregated means (via third party acquirer) of merchant on-boarding, the name of the end merchant tendering goods or services, customers point of contact must be provided.
10. The Acquirer must ensure to populate the requisite Merchant Category code (MCC) to identify the business of the merchant.
11. In case of Aggregated means (via third party acquirer), the Acquirer must ensure to populate the Merchant Category code (MCC) of the end merchant rendering goods and services.
12. The responsibility and accountability of providing the Merchant name and MCC lies with the primary acquirer, therefore any dispute, risk or fraud arising on account of negligence of the aforementioned requisites shall be the responsibility of the primary acquirer.



13. The acquirer's merchant software must comprise of the following major suite of services based on the infrastructure of the merchant:

- a. Transaction status—A confirmed status of the transaction. Success or Failed
- b. Payment status – Status of payment credit to his account.
- c. Check transaction status – A facility to verify the status of the transaction in case of no confirmation on payment or transaction.
- d. SMS/notification for every transaction – Confirmed message to assure the merchant of transaction for successful transactions.
- e. Menu options for viewing history
- f. Transaction history
- g. Helpdesk service and Instant refund
- h. Respond to Dispute or Complaint with option to upload any proof or document related to the dispute or complaint.
- i. Disputes settlement status tracking facility.

4.5 Responsibilities of Issuer:

1. The Issuer shall be responsible for facilitation of QR scan to the customer.
2. The Issuer shall make honest attempt to communicate the QR scan feature to customer and prominently place or locate, preferable on the home page, such that it is easily accessible and used by the customer.
3. The Issuer shall present the parsed information of the QR in a User Interface format with the mandatory parameters such as merchant name, transaction amount and any other parameter requiring customer inputs such as tips and remarks.
4. The Issuer application shall scan the QR, parse all the parameters of the QR and provide the customer with all the registered payment options on the app. The app must

offer the customer the right to choose his/her preferred payment option.

5. The Issuer shall not favor any payment mode or scheme or mandate the customer to choose any particular mode or scheme.
6. The Issuer shall design an intuitive User Interface or build in prompts such that the customer is alert and fully aware of the actions of authorisation (e.g PIN input) and subsequent debit to his account.
7. The Issuer must provide for the following;
 - a. Transaction confirmation page: To display the status of the transaction to the customer with transaction reference number.
 - b. Notification for every transaction or activity initiated by the customer. For example, a message to confirm the status of a transaction (Success or failed) and a change of status message of a Dispute or Complaint up to closure.
 - c. Summary of transaction: An option providing for a summary of transactions with beneficiary name and requisite details incase of a customer dispute.
 - d. Transaction inquiry page: The customer can check the status of transaction.
 - e. Option to raise a complaint or a dispute.
8. The Issuer must provide a customer service number and must prominently display the same on the App.
9. The Issuer shall take explicit customer consent for using the transaction data and record the same in the Terms of Services.

4.6 Fees and Charges:

1. No charge shall be levied on the customer for QR code-initiated transactions unless exclusively allowed by CBS. Acquirers are strictly advised to make sure that the merchants do not recover full or part of Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) from the end customer.



2. Charges may be levied on merchants in the form of Merchant Discount Rate. Merchant Acquirers shall ensure that the lowest possible MDR rates prevail in order to encourage faster and widespread adoption of QR Codes in Somalia.
3. Initially, CBS may allow market forces to determine the Merchant Discount Rate thus creating a healthy competition among Acquirers, and if required, CBS may intervene in order to regularise and stabilise the MDR.

4.7 Settlement Mechanism

The Issuer and the Acquirer shall be guided by the Operating guidelines prescribed by the respective scheme/network for Settlement and Dispute management. The settlement framework should cover the mechanism for smooth settlements.

The settlement process shall follow the settlement account maintained as per CBS regulations with the summary data it receives from the national switch Network.

1. The Network calculates the net debit or credit position based on the total netting of acquiring and issuing transactions and adjustments for a particular member.
2. In case of net debit, the member has an obligation towards other members. Thus, it owes the amount equal to the net settlement amount to other members in the network. During the settlement process, CBS debits the member which is under net debit, and credits the member under net credit. To handle this, the net debit member should hold sufficient funds in its settlement account.
3. Members should therefore ensure to fund their settlement accounts with sufficient balance to meet the settlement obligation sent by the Network. Members should periodically review daily settlement amount trends and ensure to fund their settlement accounts to avoid the out of fund situation.
4. At the end of each cutover time and completion of Settlement File generation, the Net Debit

Credit (NDC) limit would be refreshed, the net receivable or payable of each member would be generated, and a daily settlement report would be prepared and made available to all members through secured means.

5. In the event of shortfall in the account of the member at the time of settlement, the settlement would be as per the process laid down by CBS to address such scenarios in the settlement rules of the network.
6. For reconciliation purposes, the members will have to compare the report provided by the network with the report generated by members' switch and core banking system.
7. Any differences, identified during the reconciliation process, should be addressed by the members through Scheme/Network's dispute and settlement guidelines.

4.8 Risk and Compliance

1. All transactions initiating on QR must follow the Fraud and Risk management protocol similar to other legit payment modes.
2. The issuer and App provider must build velocity checks at interface level to mitigate unwanted transactions or fraud.
3. The issuers and App providers should provide for online fraud reporting mechanisms to capture and process requisite information pertaining to fraudster, to be referred and understood by the ecosystem for potential miscreants.
4. The app providers and Issuers must develop competencies to identify frauds through the usage patterns and taking appropriate measures to mitigate such risks. For example, multiple transactions within a very short span of time, changes in geolocation, frequent incorrect entries in case of generating PIN, OTP or passcode.
5. Apps taking geo-location based on consumer consent, the same may be passed on and be made available to the Issuer.



6. All the stakeholders in case of any major cyber-attack or fraud shall notify CBS as soon as possible.
7. All schemes and networks shall abide to CBS's guidelines and any circular or directives as applicable.
8. All participants shall adhere to regulatory compliance towards various laws i.e Payment and Settlement, ICT, Prevention of money laundering etc.
9. All networks shall submit annual compliance assessment to CBS.

4.9 Customer Service and Dispute Management

1. The Issuer must provide for the customer to raise a dispute or complaint from the app and ensure complaint management process as per the operating guidelines prescribed by the respective scheme/network.
2. The Issuer must provide for the customer disputes arising out of these methods of payment and design a process to address complaints raised through these channels.
3. The Acquirer must honor and facilitate a mechanism to handle complaints and disputes arising through the QR channel. They must explicitly provide for these in the terms and conditions and binding agreement with merchant.

4.10 Information Security Program

1. Security tests and security audit of the Application being used for QR Code based payment must preferably be conducted by Issuer.
2. Use of encrypted and signed API instruction between issuer, banks, network or any other participant involved must be ensured.
3. Any Personal Identifiable Information data should not be stored in the device.

4. Merchant name and masked credential must be displayed in the App after scanning a QR, to enable safe transactions.
5. The App should allow customers to have deeper understanding of security.
6. Scheme should prepare information security guidelines including;
 - a) Data Storage
 - b) Data Encryption
 - c) Channel Encryption
 - d) Infrastructure Security review – Annually
 - e) Source code review annually
 - f) Application Security – Annually
7. The Issuer must do the needful to ensure the following;
 - a) Ensure the security and confidentiality of Personal Data
 - b) Protect against any anticipated threats or hazards to the security, confidentiality and integrity of Personal Data
 - c) Protect against any actual or suspected unauthorized processing of any Personal Data.
 - d) Ensure the proper and secure disposal of Personal Data
 - e) Must undertake requisite audits to ensure safe access and usage.

4.11 Customer Education and Awareness

1. All participants should invest earnest efforts to drive education and awareness campaigns for QR payment adoption.
2. Issuers should explore to provide multi language (atleast in Somali and English) support for application as well as for customer education and awareness.
3. Issuers should provide the customer a deeper understanding of security, Consumer



education and awareness towards usage of secured Wi-Fi network or his/her own mobile network for digital transactions.

4. Awareness through intuitive User Interface, Print and Television advertisement, social media etc. Emphasis must be put on the threat and consequences of sharing sensitive personal information like PIN/OTP/CVV on phone or website or any other interface.

4.12 Interoperability compliance

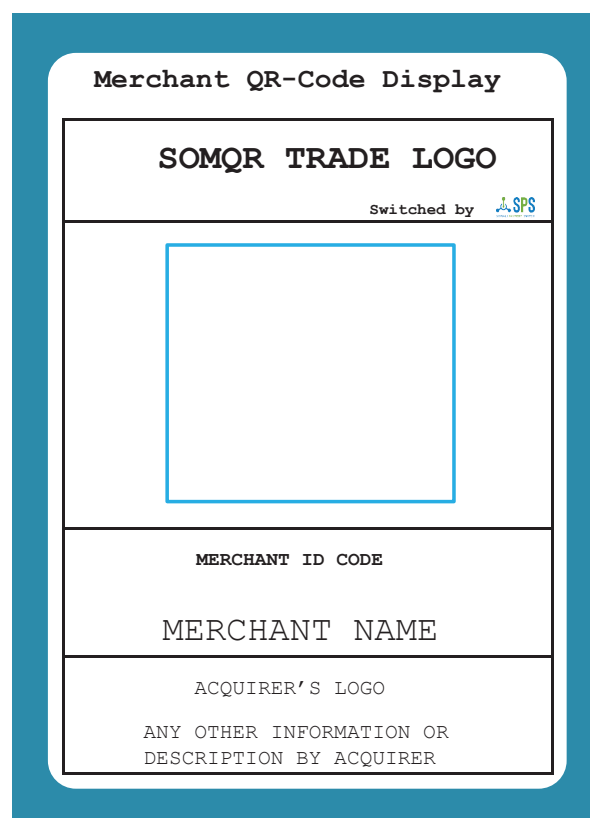
Interoperability, as the primary objective for interoperable SOMQR based payments, will be based on the following levels of interoperability.

1. Inter-Network Interoperability
 - a. Based on the primary objective of "Interoperability", any PSOs participating in Somali National QR to have payment inter-operability setup at technical level with proper settlement mechanism.
 - b. Inter-operability between networks will be further guided by the Inter-Network Settlement Guidelines issued by CBS.
2. The QR standard provides for all payment methods, therefore at the time of on-boarding the Acquirer must provide the merchant with all possible payment modes registered by the Acquirer.
3. The Issuer may provide the customer options to set any of his payment option or instrument as default, provided the customer has explicitly chosen (the default option should be pre- checked on 'No'). The app should enable the customer to change or reset the default selection during the life cycle.
4. The Issuer should never mandate or force the customer to choose a payment option, choice of payment method or instrument is explicit choice of the customer.

5. The transactions should be domestically routed and settled, if both Issuer and Acquirer are based and operated in Somalia.
6. Payment System Operators (PSOs) that use Proprietary QRs shall shift to SOMQR and no new Proprietary QRs shall be launched by any PSO for payment transaction after CBS defined date.

4.13 QR Logo And Branding

1. CBS in consultation with the concerned stakeholders, will prepare and implement the branding guidelines on usage and display of QR logo and visibility on the App.



2. The participants must be guided and compliant to the branding guidelines.
3. Acquirers must display the logo for acceptance and the App User Interface must educate and guide the customer on the App's support to scan the QR and support payment.



ANNEX I:

Somali Merchant Presented Quick Response (QR) Code Specifications

(Compliant to EMVCo. Standard)



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1. Overview

This document forms part of SOMQR Standardization Framework and Guidelines based on EMV standard version 1.0.

2. SOMQR Merchant Presented Specifications:

The QR code launched by any network or scheme operator in Somalia must adhere to SOMQR specifications in Table 1. The tag ID of the data object, the format of the value field of the data object, the length of the value field of the data object, and whether the presence of the data object at the root level of the QR Code is Mandatory (M), Conditional (C), or Optional (O).

Table 1: Shows the Data Objects Under the Root of a SOMQR

Name	Tag	Format	Length	Usage	Description
Payload Format Indicator	00	N	02	M	Defines the version of the QR code release. The first version should be numbered "01".
Point of initiation method	01	N	02	M	The first character indicates the method by which the data is presented by the merchant. The second character indicates if the data is static or dynamic. 1st character: 1 = QR 2 = BLE 3 = NFC 4-9: Reserved 2nd character: 1=static, 2=dynamic 3-9: Reserved for future use Example: "11": Static QR "12": Dynamic QR



Merchant identifier as defined by Network	02-03	ans	Each var. up to "99"	O	Reserved for Visa
	04-05				Reserved for Mastercard
	06-08				Reserved for EMVCo
	09-10				Reserved for Discover
	11-12				Reserved for Amex
	13-14				Reserved for JCB
	15-16			O	Reserved for JCB UnionPay
	17-25			O	Reserved by EMVCo.
	26			M	Reserved for Instant Payments use in Somalia
	27			O	Reserved for Instant fund transfer use in Somalia
	28-30			O	Reserved by CBS in Instant Payments use in Somalia
	31			M	To be allocated dynamically to Telcom networks as 01: Hormuud 02: Somtel
	32-51			O	To be allotted to existing and approved network, scheme operators and some are reserved by CBS.
Merchant Category Code	52	N	04	M	As defined by ISO [18245] for Retail financial services.
Transaction Currency Code	53	N	03	M	As defined by ISO[4217]. For example; 706 for Somali Shillings
Transaction Amount	54	ans	Var. up to "15"	O	This amount is expressed as how the value appears, amount "100.00" is defined as "100.00".
Tip or convenience indicator	55	N	02	O	01: Indicates that Consumer should be prompted to enter tip 02: Indicates that merchant would charge a percentage convenience fee



Value of convenience Fee fixed	56	ans	Var. up to "13"	C	The convenience fee of a fixed amount should be specified here. This amount is expressed like the value appears. Amount "100.00" is defined as "100.00".		
Value of convenience fee percentage	57	ans	Var. up to "5"	O	The Convenience Fee Percentage is specified as whole integers between 000 (for 0%) to 100 (100%). e.g 11.95" Note: 0 or 100 is not a valid value.		
Country Code	58	ans	02	M	As defined by ISO 3166.		
Merchant Name	59	ans	Var. up to "40"	M	Should always be the "doing business as" name for the merchant.		
Merchant City	60	ans	Var. upto "30"	M	City of operations for the merchant		
Postal Code	61	ans	Var. up to "10"	M	Zip code or Pin code or Postal code of merchant		
Additional Data Field	62	ans	Each var. upto "99"	O	This information may be either presented by the merchant or acquirer or the Consumer may be prompted for entry on the App. The acquirer / merchant should provide only minimum information in order to reduce the size of data. The length of each tag is variable up to 26 characters and overall it should not exceed the maximum of 99 characters for the total size of the Additional Data Field.		
					ID	Item	Description
					01	Bill number	Invoice/bill Number
					02	Mobile number	To be used for top-up or bill payment
					03	Store Label	A unique store number



					04	Loyalty number	Can be a loyalty card number from the store.
					05	Reference ID	Any value defined by the merchant / acquirer in order to identify the Transaction.
					06	Consumer ID	Refers to a subscriber ID for the service.
					07	Terminal ID	A distinctive number associated to a Terminal in the store.
					08	Purpose	Purpose of transaction e.g Airtime top-up or other services
					09	Additional consumer data	
					10-49	Reserved for future use	
					50-99	Designated range of Identifiers that are dynamically allocable	
CRC	63	ans	04	M	CRC calculated to ISO/IEC 3309 compliant 16-bit CRC which includes all the preceding TLV objects till the Tag and length value of CRC. CRC would be the last TLV object as per EMVQR standard.		



3. SOMQR Data Objects and definitions

Merchant Account Information

The Merchant Account Information template shall be used when the payment system corresponding to the Merchant Account Information is explicitly identified in the template.

Merchant Account Information for ID “26”

Name	ID	Format	Length	Presence	Description
Domain Name	“00”	ans	“14”	M	SPS instant payments reversed domain name: so.somqr.sips
Bank Acquirer ID	“01”	N	“06”	M	Assigned by CBS to all participants e.g “010001”
Money Transfer Business (MTB)	“02”	N	“06”	M	Assigned by CBS to all MTBs e.g “020001”
Other Nonbank financial institutions	“03”	N	“06”	M	Assigned by CBS to all participants e.g “030001”
Merchant ID	“44”	N	Var. up to 15	M	Merchant ID Number assigned by Acquirer e.g 12345678

All other ID codes under Tag “26” including 04 -44 and 45 -99 are reserved by CBS.

Guide for Merchant Account Information Value

- SOMQR has adopted the domain name as a Globally Unique Identifier on the sub-ID “00”. The value for this field is “so.somqr.sips”.
- The Acquirer ID (ID “01”) value shall be provided by CBS to all bank participants. The value has length of “06”. The first two digits will indicate the Acquirer category.
- The next four (4) digits for banks will be the existing bank Codes as allocated by CBS. For example, for a participant Bank F with the national code 0006, it will get acquirer ID 010006.
- For the other participants, they will be provided with new participant codes upon request as per their classification.
- The Merchant ID (ID “44”) shall contain the Merchant Identifier as defined by Acquirer and shall hold less than 15-digit alpha numeric.

Alias Merchant IDs for feature phones

In order to standardise merchant payment information for users with feature phones (non-smart phone), the following scheme would be employed to expose the merchant ID as per sub-ID “44” of ID “26”.

A unique registered merchant phone number +252 XX XXXXXXXX will be displayed as an alias merchant identifier. This will be entered by the customer into the App. The App may cross check the number and then forward to the Switch proxy subsystem.

The Alias Merchant ID may be placed on Additional Data Field Template, tag “62” under Store Label (sub-tag “03”), Terminal Label (sub-tag “07”) or any other tag related to merchant label for identifying terminals of merchant for acquirer usage.



Example: SOMQR Merchant Account Information of ID “26”.

Therefore, the Merchant Account Information of ID “26” for Bank F shall be:

26390013so.somqr.sips0106010006440812345678

The merchant ID to be displayed on the QR (for enabling input of the merchant ID by feature phones). The Alias Name – registered phone number of the merchant can also be printed and the where possible verified by the App.

Sample Bank Merchant Code for Payment in Somalia.

(a) Data Object

ID	Sample Value	Description
00	000201	Format Indicator (Version 01)
01	010211	QR Static Code (All Consumers)
26	26390013so.somqr. sips0106010006440812345678	00: Domain Name (so.somqr.sips) 01: Acquirer ID(010006 for Bank F) 44: Merchant ID (12345678)
52	52045814	MCC for restaurants service (5814)
53	5303706	Currency is Somali Shillings SOS (706)
58	5802SO	Country Code (SO for Somalia)
59	5916HAYAT RESTAURANTS	Merchant Name: HAYAT RESTAURANTS
60	6009MOGADISHU	MOGADISHU City
61	610500000	Postcode for Mogadishu City (00000)
62	622103080011678907 0511002	Store Label – 00116789 Terminal Label – 11002
63	6304D319	Cyclic Redundancy Check - Checksum

(b) Representation Data String

00020101021126390013so.somqr.sips01060100064408123456785204581453037065802SO59
16HAYATRESTAURANTS6009MOGADISHU61050000062210308001167890705110026304D319





Sample MNO Merchant Code for Payment in Somalia

ID	Sample Value	Description
00	000201	Format Indicator (Version 01)
01	010211	QR Static Code (All Consumers)
31	31350013so.somqr.sips 010201440812345678	00: Domain Name (so.somqr.sips) 01: Acquirer ID (01 for Hormuud) 44: Merchant ID (12345678)
52	52045814	MCC for restaurants service (5814)
53	5303706	Currency is Somali Shillings SOS(706)
58	5802SO	Country Code (SO for Somalia)
59	5916HAYAT RESTAURANTS	Merchant Name: HAYAT RESTAURANTS
60	6009MOGADISHU	MOGADISHU City
61	610500000	Postcode for Mogadishu City (00000)
62	622103080011678907 0511002	Store Label – 00116789 Terminal Label – 11002
63	6304A6D3	Cyclic Redundancy Check - Checksum

(c) Representation Data String

00020101021131350013so.somqr.sips0102014408123456785204581453037065802SO5916HAYATRESTAURANTS6009MOGADISHU61050000062210308001167890705110026304A6D3





ANNEX II:

Somali Person-Person (P2P) SOMQR Code Specifications



1. Introduction Person-2-Person SOMQR Code

This standard is issued to facilitate fund transfer transactions from one person to another in a convenient manner. The P2P SOMQR code is a credit transfer instrument and can only be used to receive payments by the beneficiaries of fund transfer transactions.

The use of P2P SOMQR Code will enable customers to conveniently transfer funds to beneficiaries without the burden of typing the account numbers, IBAN or other such details.

2. Scope and Applicability

This standard is applicable on all regulated entities (Banks, MFIs and others) that are offering Inter/ Intra bank fund transfer services through the digital mechanisms.

3. SOMQR P2P Specification Template

Tag ID	00	01	02	03	04	05	06	07	08-09	10
Description	Payload Format Indicator	Point of Initiation Method	Scheme Identifier	FI Name	Account number	Account Name	Amount	Particulars	Reserved for Future use	CRC

4. P2P SOMQR Data Objects

This is a proprietary template for P2P payments in Somalia with the following data objects:

Description	ID	Format	Length	Presence	Remarks
Payload Format Indicator	00	N	02	Mandatory	Value of '02' is assigned for P2P. All other values are reserved for future use
Point of Initiation Method	01	N	02	Mandatory	Indicates the nature of SOMQR '11' for Static '12' for Dynamic
Scheme Identifier	02	N	02	Mandatory	This will take values: Bank identifier: 01 Nonbank identifier: 02
FI Name	03	N	Var. upto 25	Optional	Financial Institution holding the beneficiary's account.
Account Number	04	ans	23	Mandatory	IBAN or Mobile phone Number for MNOs of the beneficiary. The QR code holder



Account Holder Name	05	ans	Var. up to 45	Mandatory	Customer name
Amount	06	N(with Two decimals	Var. up to 10	Conditional	Absent if the user is prompted to input the amount.
Particulars	07	ans	30	Optional	Particulars of the transaction. For example, Family Support, Donation, savings, Tip or convenience fee, loan disbursement or repayment between two individuals, rent payment etc.
Reserved	08-09		N/A		Reserved for Future Use by CBS
CRC	10	ans	04	Mandatory	CRC calculated to ISO/IEC 3309 compliant 16 bit CRC as per EMVQR guidelines.

5. P2P SOMQR Generation and Usage

4.1 The Financial Institutions shall generate a unique QR for their customers based on their IBAN and ensure that they are provided to their customers in all communications and product offerings including but not limited to:

- a) Mobile Applications.
- b) Internet Portals.
- c) Cheque Books.
- d) All written correspondences including welcome letters.
- e) Specially printed QR codes.
- f) QR Codes in digital forms that could be digitally sent to the customers for receiving payments, say through registered emails.

4.2 The customer may generate/download/ photograph of the QR Code via the channels mentioned above which may be used to receive payments from other individuals.

4.3 The QR Code generated for this purpose must be clear to read and of high quality so that it can be read by ordinary cameras.

4.4 Scheme identifier ID (first two digits identifying the scheme) will be issued only to the scheme desirous of offering P2P service in Somalia and authorized to do so by CBS.



As of now, the scheme IDs are issued to only two schemes as follows:

Scheme Identifier	Details
26-28	Reserved by CBS
27	Banks in Somalia
30	Non-Bank in Somalia
32-51	To be allocated to Payment Service Providers authorized by CBS

Sample Person to Person Transfer QR code:

ID	Sample Value	Description
00	000202	Format Indicator (Value 02)
01	010211	QR Static Code
02	270201	01: Scheme Identifier for banks 02: Identifier for Telecoms 03: Identifier for non-banks
03	0308SIT BANK	Financial Institution Name
04	0423SOXX0004001123456789000	Customer full IBAN number for banks Customer Phone number/Wallet ID for telecoms and non-banks.
05	0512CUSTOMER ONE	Account NAME
06	N/A	The client will be prompted to enter amount
07	0725Rent Payment for December	Transaction Particulars
10	10041323	Cyclic Redundancy Check - Checksum

SOMQR P2P Representation Data String

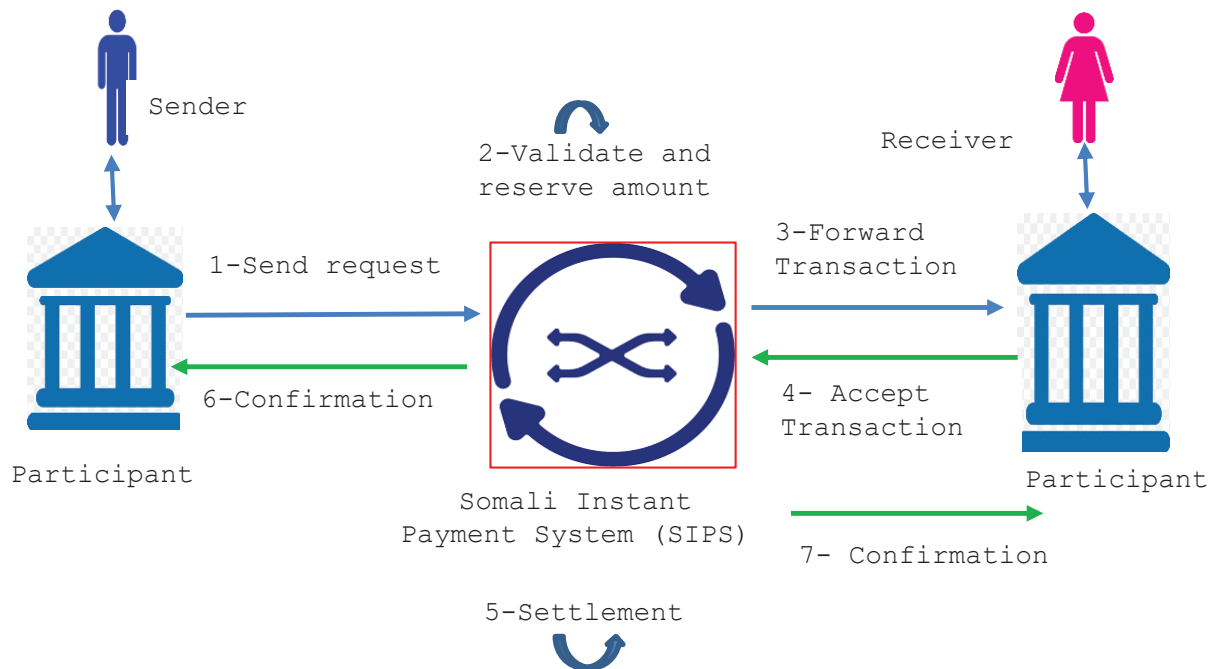
0002020102112702010308SIT BANK0423SOXX00040011234567890000512CUSTOMER ONE0725Rent Payment for December10048295





Typical QR Payment flow within the same Network:

The flow includes QR validation leg (non-financial) and the financial transaction as well.



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